BATHED IN MOONLIGHT

Deadly Encounter

Following the sound of massive wings flapping nearby reveals a shallow pond in which a **Dream Eater** bathes.

DEVELOPMENT

If disturbed, the dream eater fights for 1 Round (Level 1+) or 2 Rounds (Level 6+) before fleeing, or until destroyed (Level 12+).

OUTCOME

The iridescent surface of the pool can be collected, producing a *Nightwatcher Potion* for each character.

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BORROWED FACES

Deadly Encounter

Six wooden masks hang from a dead tree or perch, rotating slowly as if surveying the area.

DEVELOPMENT

For each mask that is plucked from its hanging place, a creature will grow in its place in 1d4 hours, which takes the shape of the character who removed the mask and menaces the area until destroyed. These imitations use the stat block of **Violet Fungus** (Level 1+) or **Awakened Tree** (Level 6+) or **Woodwarped** (Level 12+).

OUTCOME

Each hostile plant possesses a *Nectar of the Green Man* which can be collected after they are destroyed.

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BURIED OFFERING

Easy Encounter

A stone and wicker statue, overgrown with vines, stands at a crossroads, its gaping mouth stuffed with herbs and dirt.

DEVELOPMENT

Small clumps of dirt around the statue indicate that holes were dug and then backfilled, but unearthing them reveals nothing within.

OUTCOME

A character who buries something related to living things in the soil (a fresh sprig, lock of hair, or even blood) finds a *Nectar of the Green Man* under the mound of dirt they unearthed as they backfill the offering. The offering is consumed.

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BY CANDLELIGHT

Hard Encounter

The characters spy figures chanting near a flickering light in the distance, a *Black Candle*. If they investigate, they discover 4 **Cultists** (Level 1+) or 4 **Cult Fanatics** (Level 6+) or 4 **Old Ways Chosen** (Level 12+) performing a summoning ritual.

DEVELOPMENT

Left uninterrupted, the cultists manifest a **Crooked Effigy** (hostile to all creatures) after 1 minute, which consumes the black candle and attacks until destroyed.

OUTCOME

Interrupting the ritual causes the cultists to become hostile toward the characters, who benefit from the candle's Witchlight feature within its dim light.

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CIRCLE OF HUNGER

Hard Encounter

A frantic **Commoner** stands in a clearing, surrounded by snarling wolves. They cry out for help.

DEVELOPMENT

There are 3 **Wolves** (Level 1+) or 3 **Winter Wolves** (Level 6+) which can be destroyed or driven off by the characters. If the characters are Level 12+, the wolves and the commoner are an illusion produced by a nearby **Hypnovulfen** which attacks if the characters intervene.

OUTCOME

If real, saving the commoner earns their gratitude. They offer to buy each character a meal and round of drinks at the Green Queen Inn, as well as a potion of *Harvest Brew*, for their trouble.

If the commoner was an illusion, surviving the hypnovulfen attack is its own reward. A character who succeeds a DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) check notices a flask of *Sight of Sin* in the nearby undergrowth.

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HELL AT ITS HEELS

Medium Encounter

A riderless **Riding Horse**, bleeding and wild-eyed, stumbles into the characters path. A torn saddlebag dangles from its side.

DEVELOPMENT

The moment the characters approach, a number of hostile **Bat Hounds** equal to the characters level (averaged, rounded down) catch up with the horse and attack both it and the characters.

OUTCOME

Success: If the bat hounds are destroyed and the horse calmed (DC 13 Animal Handling) a **Hemonculus** that bonds with the first character it sees can be found within the saddlebag, alongside a broken vial.

Failure: If the horse escapes or is destroyed, the saddlebag contains one *Draught of the Red Hunger*.

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LAUGHING STONES

Medium Encounter

A circle of mossy stones is spotted. No sound passes through or within the circle, as though affected by a *Silence* spell.

DEVELOPMENT

When a stone is removed, the area is filled with laughter and a trapped **Kackle** appears, hostile to all creatures. Returning the stone to its position restores the silence and instantly banishes the kackle (even if it moves beyond the stone circle).

OUTCOME

If the kackle is defeated, its lantern tumbles to the floor, which has the properties of a *Cape of the Mountebank*, and the magic of the stone circle is ended.

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LEFT TO BOIL

Trivial Encounter

1 **Dingpot** sits unnattended, filled with bubbling brew, attempting to speak with 1d4 frogs (polymorphed **Commoners**). The dingpot is filled with 1d2 potions of *Lilypad Tonic*.

DEVELOPMENT

2 **Giant Owls** swoops in to capture one of the frogs and attempt to escape with a meal.

OUTCOME

Success: The frogs are defended, reverting back to commoners after 1d4 hours. The dingpot bonds with the first character who drinks one of its potions.

Failure: If any frogs perish, the dingpot loses its Brew feature.

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MAGPIE'S CHOICE

Easy Encounter

A **Magpie of Omens** perches nearby, holding a glinting trinket in its beak.

DEVELOPMENT

If a character accepts a trinket, roll a 1d2: On a roll of 1, the character has advantage on their next d20 roll. On a 2, they have disadvantage. The magpie of omens appears to the characters and makes the same offer twice more over the next two days.

OUTCOME

Success: The magpie bonds with one of the characters if they accepted all three of its gifts without being rude, even in the face of misfortune.

Failure: If disrespectful, the magpie never again approaches the characters.

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THE ONE WHO WAITED

Deadly Encounter

A dead **Commoner** perched atop a tree is spotted, clutching a large horn, apparently having been too afraid to climb down.

DEVELOPMENT

If sound above a whisper is produced within 60 feet of the tree, a **Wellwyrm** emerges from beneath the ground. The wellwyrm burrows back underground for 1 minute every time a horn or similar Musical Instrument is sounded.

OUTCOME

Success: Characters can guide the wellwyrm away from the dry earth towards a nearby waterway, where it departs in search of less challenging prey.

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PASS IT ON

Easy Encounter

A wooden signpost reads: “Pass it on.” Underneath, two bottles of *Jinxed Rum* and a single *Jinxed Poker Chip* can be found.

OUTCOME

Removing the items without replacing them with something of equal or greater value curses the takers: Until the curse is removed or the characters rectify their debt, they enter the Crooked Fortune dark bargain.

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PLUCKED FROM THE PATH

Hard Encounter

A *Bloody Fiddle* lies in the dirt on the path.

DEVELOPMENT

The first character to take or attempt to play the fiddle becomes proficient with it and instantly attunes to it. 1d4 days later, a **Bearded Devil** (Level 1+) or **Bone Devil** (Level 6+) or **Rakshasa** (Level 12+) finds the character, demanding the fiddle be returned.

OUTCOME

The creature vanishes if the fiddle is returned without conflict, leaving behind a *Devilbone Button*.

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A PRICE FOR THE HERD

Easy Encounter

2d6 **Goats** graze nervously while a **Goatstealer** watches from the trees.

DEVELOPMENT

The goatstealer does not attack—it waits. If offered a goat, it devours its meal swiftly and lingers. It refuses to accept any other food other than a live goat.

OUTCOME

If fed: The goatstealer bonds to the character who granted them permission.

If driven off or destroyed: The goats are saved.

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ROCK-A-BYE BABY

Hard Encounter

A rocking cradle is found alone—no one tends to it, and no infant rests within. Still, it gently rocks itself back and forth.

DEVELOPMENT

Upon closer inspection, a pair of silver stork scissors can be seen on the pillow of the bedding. The cradle, however, is actually a **Mimic** which attacks if a character disturbs it or attempts to take the scissors.

OUTCOME

The pair of *Midwife Shears* remain if the mimic is defeated.

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SECOND BITE OF THE CHERRY

Medium Encounter

A strange fruit-bearing tree thrives where nothing else grows. There, a ghostly orchard worker (**Wayward Haint**) tends to the tree, unable to grasp and pick the shining produce.

DEVELOPMENT

The worker is very protective of the tree, and hostile to any who approach unless they are convinced someone can help them with their final harvest.

OUTCOME

Success: Aiding the haint frees them of their tether to the world, and it offers each character one fruit as thanks (acts as a potion of *Reaper's Revenge*) before fading away.

Failure: The haint loses itself to rage and despair, and the fruits wither to nothing.

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STENCH OF GREED

Medium Encounter

The stench of a small nearby cave is so foul it can be sensed within a half mile.

DEVELOPMENT

Disturbing the entrance awakens 1d4 **Dretch** (Level 1+) or 1d6 **Ghoul** (Level 6+) or 1d4 **Deepdrecks** (Level 12+), who dwell in the cave and attack only those who enter.

OUTCOME

If the monsters are destroyed, a cache of silver bars (2d6, worth 25 GP each) is found among rotting bones and broken tools.

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THICKER THAN WATER

Hard Encounter

Just off the path, a dirty wine bottle filled with four uses of *Draught of the Red Hunger* is spotted. Its label reads Briar Public House.

DEVELOPMENT

Uncorking the bottle within 60 feet of where it was found draws the hostile attention of two **Skeletons** (Level 1+) and two **Vampire Spawn** (if Level 6+) and 1 **Vampire** (if Level 12+).

OUTCOME

Defeating the undead creatures heightens the contents of the wine bottle, as per the Heightened Brewing rules.

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A THIRST FOR STORIES

Medium Encounter

One **Moonshine** sips a bottle of *Haint Hooch* and tells bombastic stories to the shadows, asking the characters to join it for a tall tale.

DEVELOPMENT

Failing to join the moonshine attracts the wrath of a number of **Shadows** (Level 1+) or **Wights** (Level 6+) or **Wraiths** (Level 12+) equal to the number of characters. The moonshine refuses to join the fray.

OUTCOME

Success: If the characters join the moonshine, it shares a bottle of *Haint Hooch* with each of them, and bonds with the character who shared the best story.

Failure: When the Undead attackers are defeated, the moonshine fades with a melancholic whistle.

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THE THREADBARE GUIDE

Trivial Encounter

A hunched traveler (**Knight**) wrapped in rags leans on a gnarled staff. He claims to know this area well but refuses to reveal his name or anything else about himself.

DEVELOPMENT

The traveler offers each character an *Elixir of Fogwalking* and promises safe passage for their next journey in exhange for a future cost. He refuses to elaborate further.

OUTCOME

Accept: After their next long rest, the characters Hit Dice are reduced by half (rounded down). The next time the characters trek overland, their journey is shrouded in mist, and the travel time is reduced to 1 hour regardless of distance.

Refuse: The traveler offers their thanks and continues on their way.

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THREAD OF AFFECTION

Trivial Encounter

One **Witchwoven** sits at a tiny, makeshift dinner table. When approached, the witchwoven temporarily bonds with the characters so they can communicate.

DEVELOPMENT

The witchwoven waits nervously for a **Corn Dolly** to arrive for a romantic date. Without guidance, they'll fail to charm their beloved.

OUTCOME

Success: With the right advice, the corn dolly agrees to continue courtship. Before leaving together, the witchwoven imbues the characters with the effects of the *Heroism* (+4 spellcasting modifier), which lasts for 24 hours.

Failure: Rejected, the witchwoven produces a *Tincture of Mourning* before unraveling.

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UNDER THE BRIDGE

Easy Encounter

A dilapidated stone bridge spans a dry riverbed. Below, a **Salmon of Knowledge** flops on the parched ground, having lost its orb of water.

DEVELOPMENT

The salmon of knowledge suffocates in 1d4 + 1 minutes, dissolving into foam without its orb. Attempts to rehydrate the salmon of knowledge without the orb only slow its demise.

OUTCOME

Success: The orb of water is nearby, either trapped in a crevice of the riverbed or taken by a badger into its den. If found and returned to the salmon of knowledge, it bonds with the character who saved it.

Failure: If the salmon of knowledge suffocates it dissolves into the riverbed, never to return.

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WELL WISHES

Medium Encounter

A dry stone well stands alone. To those who look into its depths, a faint voice calls out for aid.

DEVELOPMENT

The voice belongs to a lingering spirit trapped within the well. It asks that something of sentimental value be dropped into the well.

OUTCOME

Accept: Anything dropped into the well is lost to the lingering spirit within, but a **Ghost Crawler** emerges from the well and bonds with the former owner.

Refuse: The spirit turns bitter, and a **Will-o'-Wisp** emerges and attacks until destroyed.

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USING THIS DECK

This NPCs & Encounters deck is your quick-reference tool for running non-player characters and adding thematic chance encounters to your adventure in *The Crooked Moon*. Each NPC card contains:

CHARACTER OVERVIEW. The NPC Name, Species/Type, Alignment, and Appearance.

INTERACTIONS. Friendly, indifferent, and hostile attitude suggestions that can influence roleplay.

NOTABLE POSSESSIONS. A list of items the NPC carries. You have discretion to add or remove from this list as needed for the story.

The front of each NPC card features character art that can be shared with your players (without revealing the NPCs details).

Each Encounter card contains unique situations you can introduce throughout *The Crooked Moon* campaign, or used as part of any folk horror adventure. The other reference card in this deck includes guidance for using them effectively.

Remember, this deck is an aid, not a replacement for the NPCs and encounters in *The Crooked Moon*. Refer to the full book when using these NPC cards.

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ENCOUNTERS IN PLAY

The Encounter cards in this deck are designed to provide unexpected and engaging scenarios the characters might stumble upon during overland travel in *The Crooked Moon*. Before using this deck, take a moment to familiarize yourself with the potential encounters—you'll need to fill in the details based on your campaign's tone and player preferences.

DRAW AN ENCOUNTER. When the party is traveling, resting, or exploring you can shuffle all 22 encounter cards and draw a card to introduce a unique event.

SET THE SCENE. Establish the mood and present the initial scenario after reviewing the encounter.

PRESENT THE CHOICE. Players may respond however they wish—engaging directly or avoiding entirely. Use the Development to evolve the encounter as choices are made.

RESOLVE THE OUTCOME. Use the suggested guidance to determine the results of the player's choices—consequences or rewards, often based on their success or failure in the encounter. Some encounters may resolve quickly, while others can have lingering influence on the campaign that can last much longer.

Not all of these encounters lead to combat. They should be used to add interest to your adventure. Use your judgment when introducing one of these encounters—some are trivial in challenge, while others are potentially very deadly. You may opt to choose an encounter instead of drawing one randomly, at your discretion.

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